UNSW MARKETING ANALYTICS HACKATHON 2026 · FINALIST

# Getting slow loans funded faster

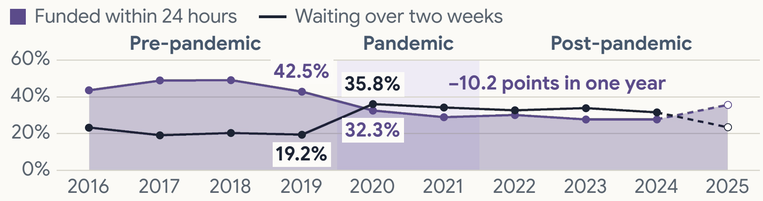


What 1.45 million Kiva loans say about predicting slow loans and supporting them

**Mike Nguyen and Sophia Nguyen, Team Cultural Blend, University of Technology Sydney**

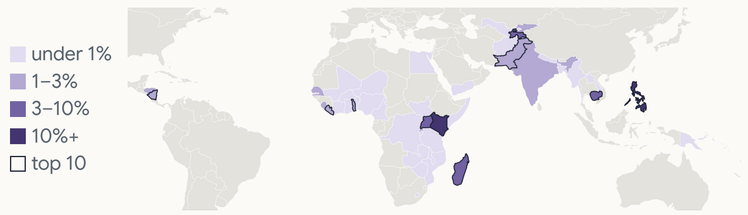
## PROBLEM

### Waits got longer after 2019: a third of loans now wait over two weeks




Open markers: 2025 may be incomplete.

### Over half of all two-week waits come from just three countries



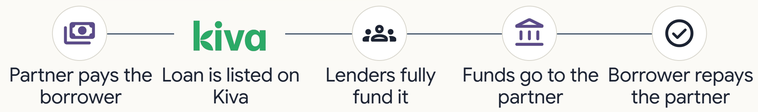

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Kenya** | 96,997 (36.4%) | |
| **Philippines** | 89,412 (17.1%) | |
| **Tajikistan** | 34,434 (50.0%) | |
| Uganda | 24,372 (35.0%) | |
| Nicaragua | 17,580 (45.6%) | |
| Pakistan | 16,474 (38.5%) | |

Within 24 hours · 1 day to 2 weeks · Over 2 weeks: loans (share of its loans)

## EVIDENCE

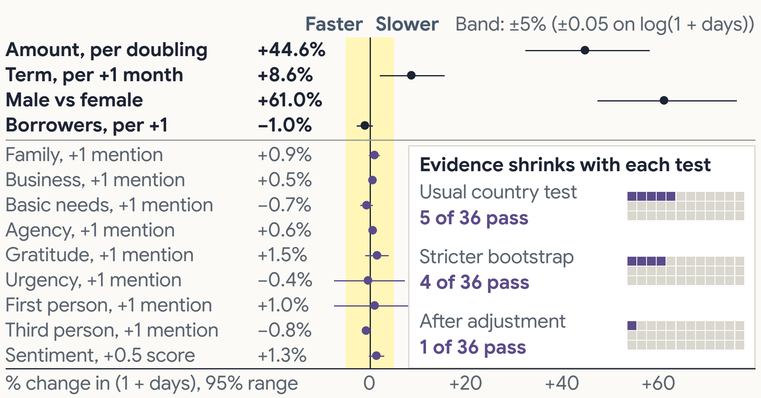
### Borrowers usually have the money before lenders fund the loan

Borrower has the money: **median 24.2 days** · We measure: **median 2.85 days**




**96.4%** of loans reach the borrower before listing

### Slow funding is a lender-side delay that loan details predict, not wording




One tiny signal passes the strictest test, but not with programme controls.

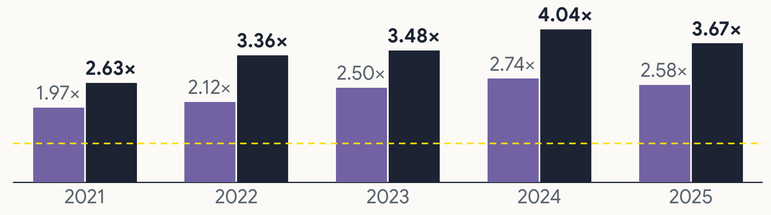
## SOLUTION

### Our solution: predict slow loans, prioritise support, test before advising

| Step | What | How |
|---|---|---|
| **Predict** Retrospective check only | Score each listing's **risk of slow funding** when it is posted. | A boosted tree on loan structure; text adds little to this score. |
| **Prioritise** Needs a pilot | Send **lender-side support** to flagged loans. | Featuring, matching funds, lender alerts and partner follow-up. |
| **Test** Not started | Earn the right to give **writing advice**. | Pass three gates before any advice. |

### A flag at listing beats a simple historical lookup in every year

**2.6–4.0×** as many of the slowest fifth as a random pick, funded loans only




The gap's 95% range is **above zero every year**. Median within-country precision: **0.49–0.56** vs 0.22–0.29 for the lookup (random 0.20).

## NEXT STEPS

### Four limits decide what the solution can claim today

**Associations, not causes**
Pilot each lever and prompt **against a control**.

**Funded loans only**
Add **expired listings** before judging reach.

**Uneven across countries**
Recalibrate and validate the flag **country by country**.

**For whom and when**
Treat **weak signals** as hypotheses to test.

**Flag slow loans first.**
**Earn writing advice last.**

**OUR ASK TO KIVA**

**NOW** **One partner** to pilot the flag

**NEXT** **Expired listings** and **country data**

**LATER** A partner for **one prompt pilot**

**393,847**
27.1% of all loans waited over two weeks

**Cultural Blend** Code, saved results and every number: github.com/tuannm3812/unsw-ma-hackathon-2026 Data: 1,453,840 completed Kiva loans, 2016–2025